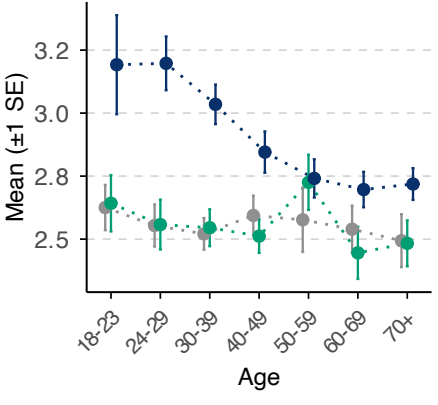
Need wealthy family to get ahead

GSS, 1987-2021 data

5=Essential
1=Not important at all

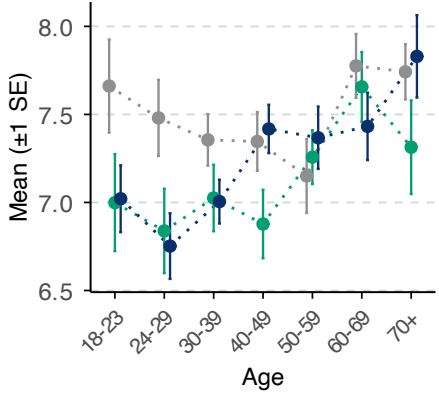


1987 2000 2021

Hard work usually brings a better life

WVS (US), 1995-2017 data

10=Hard work brings success
1=Luck/connections matter more

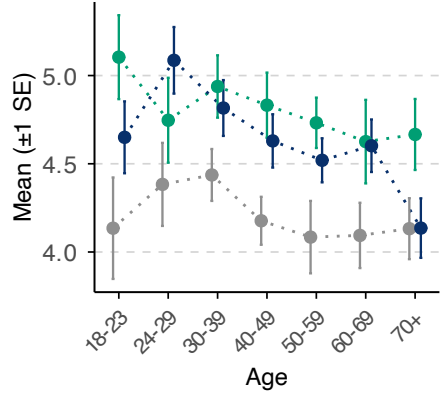


1995 2006 2017

Wealth is zero-sum – people can only get rich at others' expense

WVS (US), 1995-2011 data

10=Only get rich at others' expense
1=Wealth can grow for everyone



1995 2006 2011